Event Details

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Meta Global AI Developer Hackathon Participant Guide

Welcome to the Meta Global AI Developer Hackathon (the “Hackathon”)! We’re thrilled to have you on board.

This guide is your all-in-one resource for the event, including schedule, rules, technical resources, problem statements, judging information, and more. Please read this carefully; most answers can be found here.

1. Your Goal: Hackathon Problem Statements

Your project must build towards one of the following problem statements:

Build for Your World - Bring Meta's models into your domain. Solve a problem you know firsthand, free up time and mental space, and make something possible that wasn't before.

challenges in software, robotics,
ive a machine a new capability,
etter way to understand and
es possible when these models

se the Muse Spark series, Muse
d SAM 3.1 through Meta Model API,
nd Muse Spark Open, and code

:ipants, get official updates, begin



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Getting Started:

Introduce yourself: In #intros, share who you are, the skills you bring, and what project you're looking to build.

Create a Team (optional): In #team-search, find teammates before the Hackathon (maximum team size of 4)

Key Channels include:

#general: Socialize and meet other hackers.

#announcements: Official updates and reminders from the CV Team.

#intros: Introduce yourself and what you're doing to everyone!

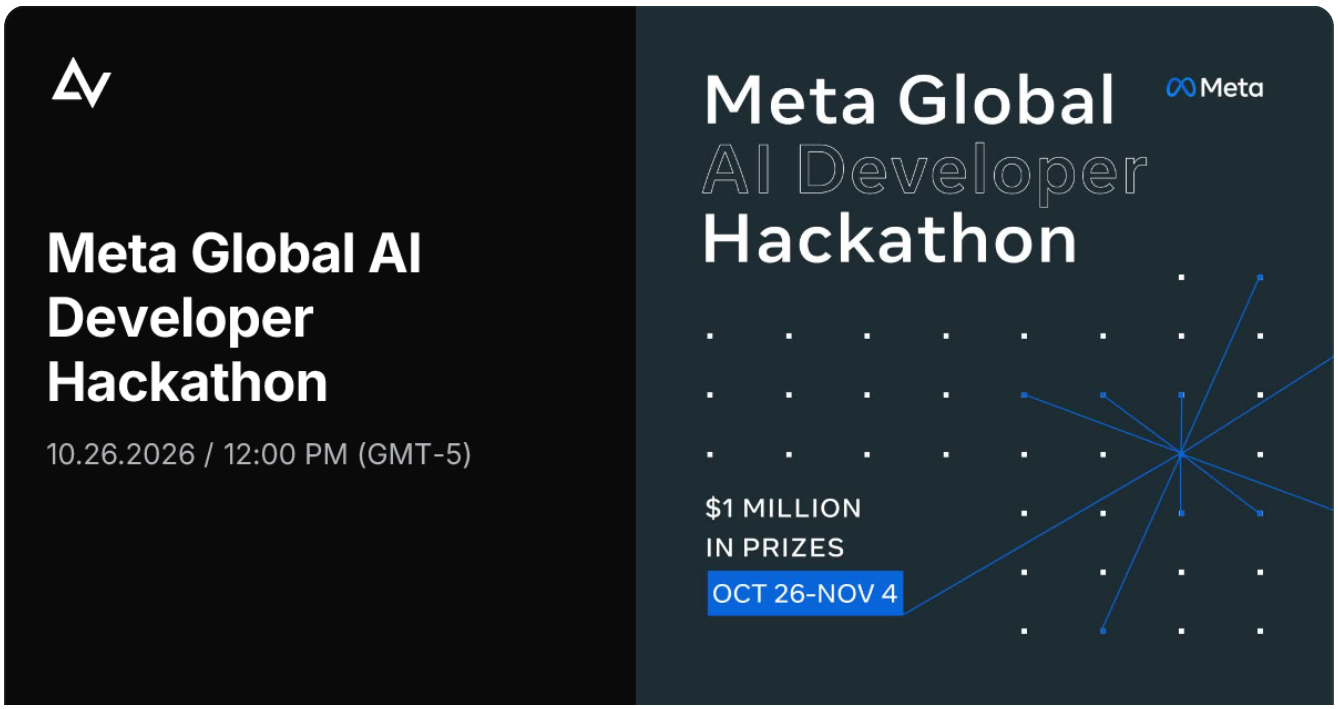
#team-search: Find teammates before the Hackathon (maximum team size of 4).

#questions: Ask any general questions to @Cerebral Valley. Any specific questions not mentioned in the resources you can direct to the Cerebral Valley team role.

#office-hours: Ask the Meta team questions.

3. Schedule Overview

All sessions will be streamed live at the following link:



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The stream will be available shortly before the start of the sessions.

Please note: All times are in Eastern Time (ET).

Kickoff

Mon, Oct 26 | 12:00 PM: Opening remarks, hackathon overview, rules, prizes, judging, and Meta speaker kickoff.

Building & Live Sessions

Tue, Oct 27 | 12:00 PM-1:00 PM: Agents 101: Build a Multimodal AI Agent

- Speakers: Suraj Subramanian

Wed, Oct 28 | 12:00-1:00 PM: Agents 102: Best Practices for Verifiable Agents

- Speakers: Yash Khare

Friday, Oct 30 | 12:00-1:00PM: Building Specialized Intelligence on Fireworks: From Inference to Training with Muse Open Models

- Speaker: Sinan Ozdemir

Throughout the building period (except for weekends): Daily channel office hours in Discord from 10-11 AM ET. Meta team members will answer questions directly in the #office-hours channel via text. No livestream or live video sessions.

Submission Deadline

Tue, Nov 3: Last full day for submission questions and technical troubleshooting. Deadline reminders posted throughout the day.

Wed, Nov 4 | 9:00 PM: Final office hours in Discord; Submissions due via the CV platform.

Judging & Closing Ceremony

Thu, Nov 5 – Sun, Nov 8: Judging Period

Mon, Nov 9 | 12:00 PM: Closing ceremony. Top 10 teams announced (5 per track), live final-round judging, winners revealed, and community vote opens.

Mon, Nov 16: Community vote winner announced on Discord.

Building period: Oct 27 – Nov 4

4. Hackathon Rules

Open source: Repositories must be public.

Team size: A maximum of four participants per team. Solo participants are allowed.

Demo requirements: Your demo must only highlight the specific features, code, and functionality that you built during the Hackathon. Judges must be able to clearly identify what was created during the Hackathon. Failure to clearly identify your original contributions will result in immediate disqualification at Judges sole discretion.

New work only: What you present at this Hackathon must have been built

during the event. This should be clear in your submissions. Startups may build on existing products or codebases, but you must clearly identify what was newly developed during the Hackathon.

Banned projects: Projects will be disqualified if they: violate legal, ethical, or platform policies, use code, data, or assets you do not have the rights to.

Sample Anti-Projects

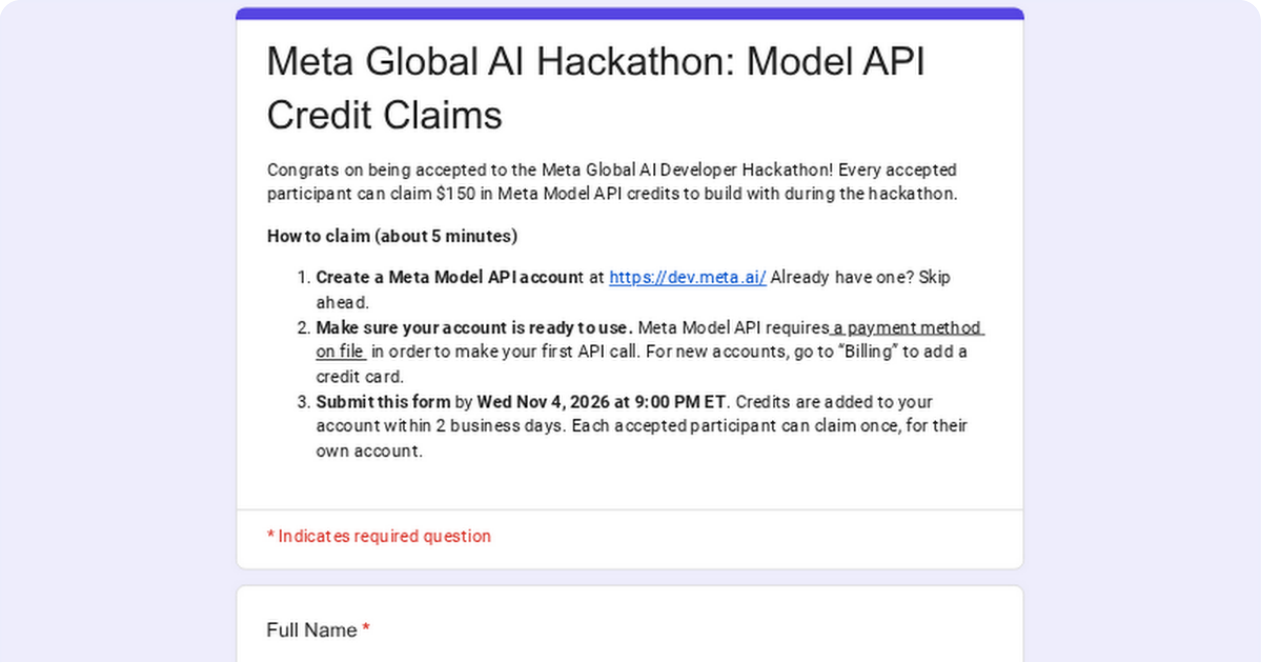
The following list contains project examples that are generic (seen across many hackathons) or violate platform policies. This is not an exhaustive list, but please make sure to avoid building: Any project using AI to generate and give medical advice e.g. AI Mental Health Advisor, skin blemish detector, etc.; Basic RAG Applications; Simple Image Analyzers; simple "AI for Education" Chatbots; AI Job Application Screener; AI Nutrition Coach; Personality Analyzers; Sports analyzers or coaches; Anything political or involving war

5. Meta Provided Resources

Claim your $150 in Meta Model API credits

As an accepted participant, you get $150 in Meta Model API credits.
To claim:

Apply for credits through this form.



> Once the form is submitted, credits will be distributed in batches. Check the 'Billing' page to ensure free credits are applied. In order to use your credits & make an API call, a credit card must be applied to your account. **Upon providing a valid payment method a temporary pre authorization charge will show up on your card, this will be released automatically within a few business days*
>
> You can set up a "Spend Limit" notification on the "Billing" page if you do not want to spend beyond the $150 credit granted.

Claim by Wed Nov 4 at 9:00 PM Eastern Time. Each participant - solo, team member, or startup entrant - must claim their own credits individually. Credits cannot be claimed on someone else's behalf.

Helpful Resources:

Docs

- Overview
- Quickstart guide
- Model list

Cookbook

- API cookbook
- API fundamentals
- Muse code recipes
- OSS model cookbook

On Demand Sessions

- The multimodal intelligence of Muse Spark
- Building with Muse Spark and Muse Code: from capabilities to production
- The road ahead: the superintelligence blueprint and what's next

6. Inference Partner Provided Resources

Disclaimer: Credits are not guaranteed and are distributed at the sole discretion of each partner.

Baseten

📚 Resources

- Quickstart: Make your first API call in minutes
- Chat Completions API: Python, JavaScript, and cURL examples
- Reasoning: Understand and read Muse Spark Open's reasoning output
- Vision and Audio: Send images and audio to Muse Spark Open
- **Request $100 in Baseten credits + a 2M TPM rate limit**: Available to up to 2,000 participants. Requests are reviewed based on use case, and selected applicants will be notified by email. Credits are granted per individual, not per team.

⚠️ Important: The docs use meta-models/muse-spark-open. For the hackathon, use meta-models/muse-spark-open-1026 instead.

🙋 Need help?

Find the Baseten team in the Hackathon Discord's Baseten channel. Happy building!

Modal

📚 Resources

Introduction to Modal: Get started with Modal's AI infrastructure platform.

Request $100 in Modal credits here. Modal is offering $100 in credits to the first 1,000 participants, for running Meta's open-weight models through Endpoints, in addition to our serverless GPUs, sandboxes, and tools for LLM training.

🙋 Need help?

Visit the Modal documentation to get started.

Fireworks

📚 Resources

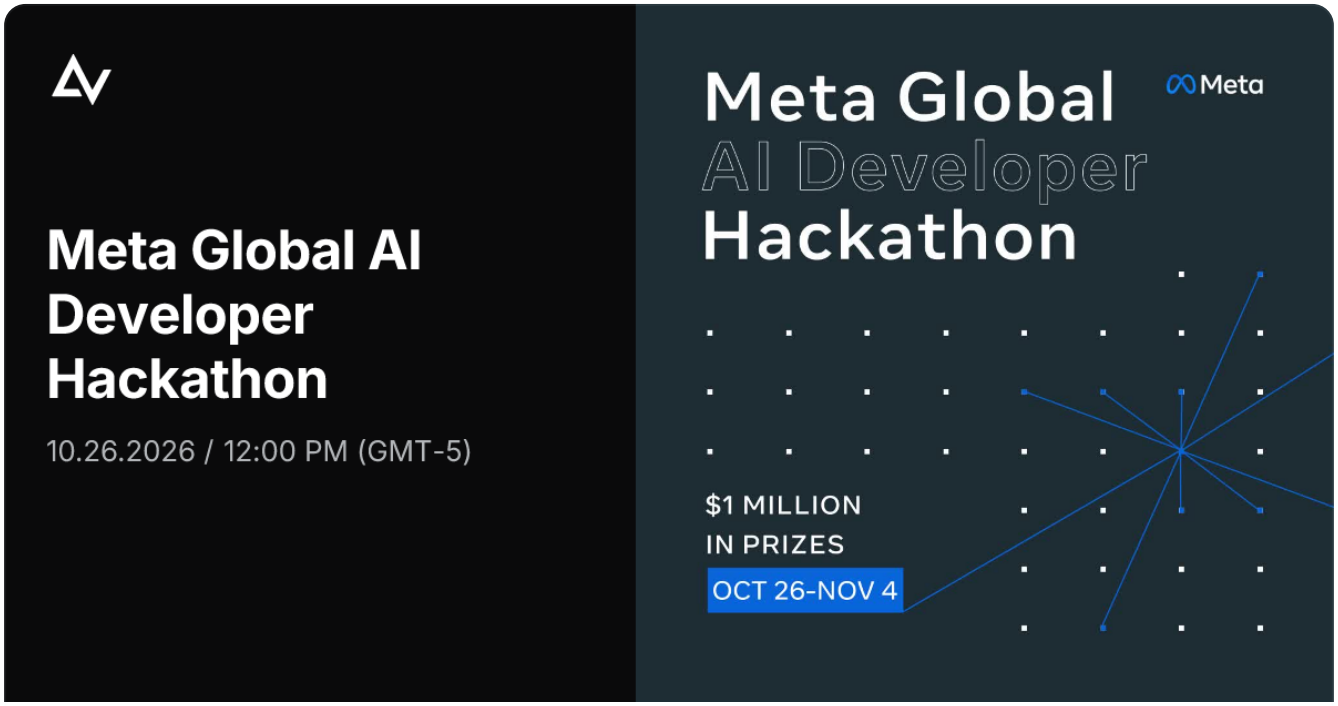
Request $25 in Fireworks credits for your team. Credits go to a shortlist of select teams reviewed with Fireworks. If your team is selected, we will email you the redemption details.

7. Submission Process

Solo participants, teams and startups must submit here by November 4 at 9:00 PM EST. Teams and startups submit one project, not one submission per person. Late submissions won't be considered.

Each team must appoint one individual (the "Representative") to represent and act on behalf of the team and/or startup, including by entering the submission project.

Please double-check that your repository is accessible publicly, your video link is accessible, and everyone who worked on the project is listed on the submission page.



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Please note: Your submission will require a three minute demo video highlighting the specific features, code, and functionality you built during the Hackathon. This video will also be used as one of the primary artifacts Judges use to judge your project, along with your code and live product.

8. Judging Process

Judging Process will happen in three stages:

Stage One: The first stage will determine via pass/fail whether the ideas meet a baseline level of viability, in that the Project reasonably fits the theme and reasonably used Meta Model API and/or Meta's open-weight models to build the project in the Hackathon.

Stage Two: All Submissions that pass Stage One will be evaluated in Stage Two based on the following criteria using a scale from 0-10:

Judging Rubric

Category	Description

(Weight)	
Impact (30%)	What's the real-world potential here? Who benefits, and how much does it matter? Could this actually become something people use? Does it fit into one of the problem statements listed above?
Use of Meta AI Tooling (25%)	How creatively did this team use Meta's AI tooling? Did they go beyond a basic integration? Did they surface capabilities that surprised even us?
Technical Depth & Execution (20%)	Is the engineering sound and thoughtfully refined? Does this feel like something that was thought through with real craft.
Demo (25%)	Is this a working, impressive demo? Does the product hold up live? Is the demo video genuinely cool to watch?

Stage Three: The top 5 scoring projects per track move on to a final round of judging, where final round Judges will watch the video demos live and rank them using the same rubric.

9. Prizes

The Hackathon will feature **two primary competition tracks, Indie Developer and Startups, plus additional bonus prizes** recognizing standout projects across the Hackathon.

Total Prize Pool: $1,000,000 across 2 tracks

Track: Indie Developer (total $400,000)

Place	Prize
1st	$150K
2nd	$100K
3rd	$75K

4th	$50K
5th	$25K

Track: Startups (total $550,000)

Place	Prize
1st	$250K
2nd	$150K
3rd	$75K
4th	$50K
5th	$25K

Bonus Prizes from Meta: $50K

An additional $50K will be reserved for bonus awards recognizing standout projects and community achievements.

Prize	Prize	What it rewards	How it is judged
Most Viral Project	$20,000	The project that generates the highest engagement on X after the Event.	Post your project demo on X and submit the post link through the hackathon platform. The winner will be selected based on total engagement (likes, reposts, and comments) up until November 8 EOD.
Best Build on Meta Open	$10,000	The best project built using Muse	Projects are flagged during the first

Weight Models		Glimmer or Muse Spark Open, served on participants' own hardware or through partner-provided inference.	judging round. The infrastructure partner verifies that the project runs on an eligible Meta open-weight model.
Community Vote	$10,000	The project that receives the most votes in the public gallery. The winner will be announced November 16.	The winner is determined by the total number of votes received through the hackathon platform, limited to one vote per verified account.
Best Agentic Use-Case	$5,000	The project that makes the strongest use of AI agents to complete meaningful tasks, make decisions, or coordinate multi-step workflows.	Judges evaluate the project's level of autonomy, effectiveness in completing its intended task, and practical usefulness.
Best Creative Build	$5,000	The most original and compelling creative project built using Muse Image or Muse Wonder.	Projects are flagged during the first judging round and evaluated on creative originality, execution, and how effectively the model is used in the final experience.